Dieter Hollenbeck

Systems Engineer

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SUMMARY

Systems engineer for sixteen years, with a steady move from physical servers to software-defined infrastructure. Currently I design and run a private cloud on OpenStack with Ansible, Nomad and Consul for a manufacturer. Pragmatic, security-minded and fond of reproducible builds. I am a long-time contributor on a regional Linux user group and maintain a handful of Ansible roles that I have published for others to reuse.

SKILLS

OpenStack, Ansible, Nomad, Consul, Packer, GitLab CI, Prometheus, Alertmanager, Ceph, Linux, Bash, Python, WireGuard

EXPERIENCE

Senior Systems Engineer, Schwarzwald Maschinenbau AG — 2018 – Present

- Run a private cloud with 1,200 vCPUs for plant analytics, supporting 14 internal teams.
- Automate every host with Ansible and Packer images; a full rebuild of the control plane takes under two hours.
- Schedule workloads with Nomad and Consul service discovery; roll out new versions with canary releases from GitLab CI.
- Led the hardening effort for an ISO 27001 audit.
- Replaced manual quarterly patching with scheduled, rolling maintenance that never drops production lines.
- Implemented WireGuard tunnels for secure connections between the plants and the central private cloud.
- Maintain a documented disaster recovery plan, including offline copies of configuration, keys and images stored in a separate fire zone.
- Coordinate with plant electricians on power and cooling upgrades for the server rooms.

Systems Engineer, Neckar Software GmbH — 2013 – 2018

- Operated KVM virtualisation clusters and Ceph storage.
- Introduced configuration management with Puppet, later Ansible.
- Built monitoring around Nagios and subsequently Prometheus.
- Built an image pipeline with Packer, producing signed golden images every week.
- Set up Prometheus federation across three sites with alert routing by ownership.
- Rolled out centralised logging with Loki and a small set of dashboards used by the factory support desk.

IT Administrator, Fildern Handels GmbH — 2010 – 2013

- Maintained Linux and Windows servers, mail and backups for 120 staff.
- Gained deep experience with RAID, backup and disaster recovery on commodity hardware.

EDUCATION

- Diplom Informatik (FH), Hochschule Rheinbach-Süd (2005 – 2010)

LANGUAGES

German (native), English (C1)

CERTIFICATIONS

- LPIC-3 Enterprise